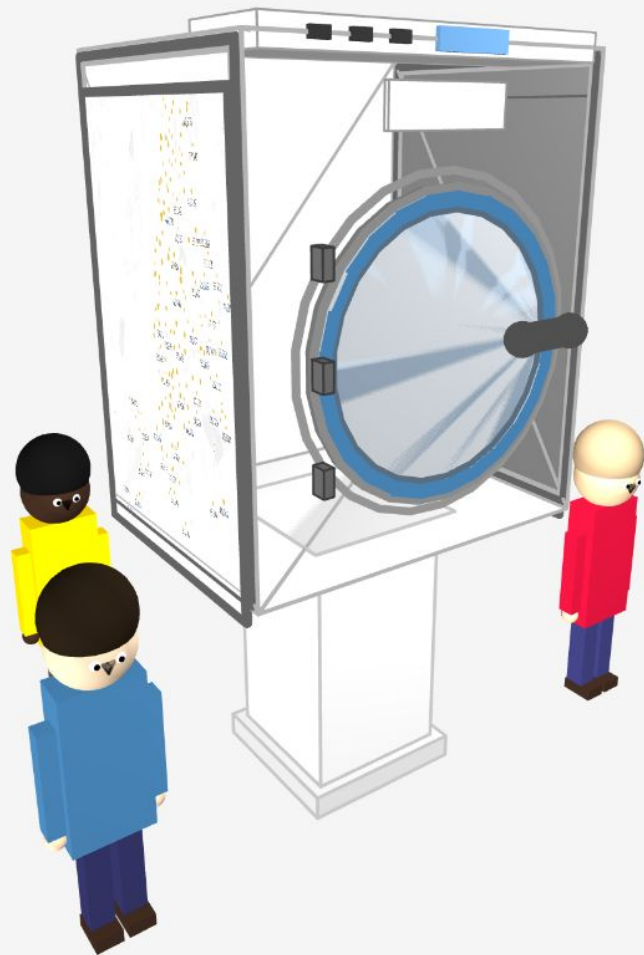


Laundromat Convergence: Cycle of Necessity

This project illustrates how the laundromat business has become a deeply rooted part of New York City's culture. By weaving together census demographics, water-complaint distribution, laundromat business distribution, and a heatmap of total assessed property values, it shows how laundromats have continued to thrive and remain essential in densely populated neighborhoods in NYC, despite the city's consistent water challenges.



- Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art
Burt Kim

Next Steps and Exhibition Plan

Materials Setup:

Distance sensor, Raspberry Pi 4, ESP 32, drier machine, speaker, NYC water complaints LED map, and distribution maps with explanations.

Specific updates planned:

1. Order necessary parts.
2. Design additional components to be displayed on the sides of the washing machine and inside the drum.

Extra Info:

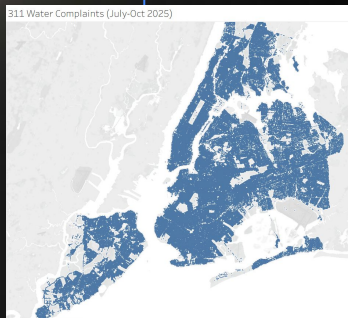
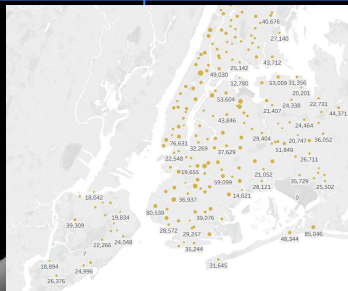
I have previously used the Cooper Media Lab for printing high-quality, laser-printed materials.



Timeline

We began by exploring NYC datasets and asking what everyday element—often overlooked as ‘culture’—is actually essential to city life.

That led us to focus on laundromats, and we dug into every related dataset we could find.



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Reflection

Working through the datasheets, cleaning the datasets, and refining them into a usable form helped me learn how to handle data from start to finish. Preparing for the exhibition also made me think carefully about how to communicate my message effectively to the audience.

The biggest challenge, however, was finding a washing machine or dryer for the installation, and I'm grateful to Professor Shoushtary for helping me locate one. Setting everything up was tricky as well—especially because the Raspberry Pi's power connection was so sensitive that even a slight movement could shut it off. I used two external parts, a speaker and a distance sensor, but the speaker wasn't always detected due to the Raspberry Pi's boot-up behavior.

Despite all these challenges, I'm genuinely proud of how the installation turned out. The experience gave me confidence that I can work with any dataset and present it in a way that audiences can understand and connect with.